

▲ Plate 8.12 Sign of Spoilage in Canned Foods

In case any one or more signs are noted it should be discarded without tasting the contents.

9. *Frozen foods:*

It is very difficult to identify the spoilage in frozen foods unless there is change in colour or smell. If following precautions are taken, food borne illness can be prevented.

- Do not use frozen foods if there is off smell, taste or discolouration.
- Do not re-freeze food which has been thawed.
- Thaw only required amount.
- Do not purchase damaged packages.
- Do not keep frozen foods out of the freezer for long before cooking.
- Do not accept food which has a large quantity of ice crystals formed inside the packet.

Food that is decayed is easier to recognize than spoilt by microorganisms. Always the spoilt foods should be discarded and should not be consumed so as to prevent food poisoning and infections.

8.3 Food Poisoning and Prevention

Food poisoning is caused by the ingestion of food or drink, contaminated with bacteria or toxins. The term 'food borne disease' is defined as a disease usually either infectious or toxic in nature, caused by agents that enter the body through the ingestion of food.

Types of Food Poisoning

Food poisoning may be of two types

a. Non- bacterial: Caused by chemicals such as arsenic, certain plant and sea foods. Lathyrism and endemic ascitis are some diseases caused due to toxins in foods. In recent years there has been a growing concern about contamination of food by chemicals (eg) fertilizers and pesticides.
b. Bacterial: Caused by the ingestion of food contaminated by living bacteria or other toxins.

DO YOU KNOW?

More than 200 diseases are spread through food

Millions of people fall ill every year and many die as a result of eating unsafe food. Diarrhoeal diseases alone kill an estimated 1.5 million children annually, and most of these illnesses are attributed to contaminated food or drinking water. Proper food preparation can prevent most food borne diseases.

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